BUSWATCH · PRODUCT PLAN

Feature roadmap: getting passengers to come back

A phased plan for new features that increase passenger engagement, build public trust and give the admin team better tools. November 2026.

Summary

Today a passenger visits BusWatch once, submits a report, perhaps checks the tracking page, and leaves. There is no reason to return and little evidence that reporting changes anything. This plan adds features in four phases, ordered by impact for the effort, so that passengers feel heard, see results, get brought back, and tell others.

Goal	What it means in practice
1. Answer them	Passengers should feel heard: replies, updates and a way to rate the outcome.
2. Show results	Make the impact visible in public: totals, trends, resolved cases.
3. Bring them back	Notifications (SMS, push, email) and a personal “My reports” page.
4. Spread the word	QR codes on buses, sharing, and Sinhala and Tamil versions of the site.

Where to start: Sinhala and Tamil plus the bus QR codes (most new reports), then the outcome rating plus the public impact page (passengers see that reporting works), then messages between admin and passenger (most useful for the admin team).

Phase 1: Quick wins

About 2 weeks. Effort assumes one developer working in the current codebase (S = 1–2 days, M = 3–5 days, L = 1–2 weeks).

Feature	Why it helps	What it takes	Effort
Sinhala and Tamil versions	Probably the biggest single gain in reach. Many passengers won't fill in an English form.	next-intl in the UI; translated email and PDF receipt templates in the API; language switch in the header.	M
QR code per bus	Puts the app where incidents happen. A sticker inside the bus opens the form with the bus number filled in.	Short link /r/NB-1234 that redirects to /submit-report?bus=NB-1234; admin button to print a QR sheet.	S
Installable app with offline drafts	People report from the bus, often with a weak signal. The draft is kept and sent when back online.	Web app manifest (already exists) and a service worker; store the draft in IndexedDB.	M

Feature	Why it helps	What it takes	Effort
“Commend a driver”	Balances complaints with good news and gives a happier reason to use the app. Operators are more willing to take part.	New report type with a lighter form; shown separately in analytics.	S
Rate the outcome	Closes the loop: “Were you satisfied with how this was handled?” Also measures the admin team.	rating and feedback columns; 1–5 rating on the tracking page once resolved; link in the resolution email.	S
Share a tracking link	Passengers forward it to family or post that BusWatch fixed something.	Share button using the browser share sheet; preview image for social media.	S

Phase 2: Show the results publicly

2–3 weeks. The admin analytics already hold the interesting data; today only admins can see it.

Feature	Why it helps	What it takes	Effort
Public impact page (/impact)	Shows that reporting works: reports received, resolved this month, time to resolve, trends.	New public /api/public/stats endpoint returning totals only, cached; Next.js rebuilds the page every few minutes.	M
Incident heatmap	Shows where problems cluster, by route or area.	Uses the existing map pins, shown grouped. Never individual points.	M
Bus and route scorecard (/bus/NB-1234)	Accountability per bus: reports, resolved, commendations.	Only shown once a bus has a minimum number of admin-checked reports (for example 3).	M
Resolved case stories	Concrete proof that reporting changes things.	Admins choose and anonymise cases, e.g. “Route 08 overcharging: operator issued refunds.”	S

> **Fairness risk.** Without a minimum threshold and admin review, one angry person could damage an operator's reputation through the public scorecard. That is both a fairness and a legal problem.

Phase 3: Two-way contact

3–4 weeks.

Feature	Why it helps	What it takes	Effort
“My reports” without passwords	Gives passengers a home in the app and a reason to return.	Passenger enters email or phone and gets a one-time code; passenger session separate from admin login.	L
Messages between admin and passenger	Today admins can't get back to a passenger once the report is in (“Which seat were you in?”).	report_messages table; reply box on the tracking page; uses the existing email notifications.	M

Feature	Why it helps	What it takes	Effort
SMS or WhatsApp updates	In Sri Lanka these reach far more people than email.	Twilio, or a local SMS gateway such as Dialog's or Notify.lk. Phone number optional, as email is now.	M
Browser push notifications	“Your report was escalated” without giving an email address.	Builds on the installable app from Phase 1 (Web Push).	M

Phase 4: Wider ecosystem

Ongoing.

Feature	Why it helps	What it takes	Effort
“Me too” confirmations	Stronger evidence and fewer duplicate reports.	When several passengers report the same bus, day and category, offer “Did you see this too? Add your confirmation.”	M
Operator portal	Turns BusWatch into a working accountability system rather than a complaint box.	Bus owners log in, see reports about their own fleet, reply or record what they did. New admin role.	L
AI help for admins	Faster, more consistent handling, and better privacy for people in photos.	Suggest a category; translate Sinhala or Tamil descriptions; summarise long reports; blur faces and number plates in photos.	L

Things to protect before going public

- **Privacy:** public pages show totals only. Never show passenger details or exact timestamps next to a location.
- **Abuse:** submissions already have rate limits and a hidden spam field. Before any public scorecards, add a CAPTCHA (Cloudflare Turnstile) and require admin approval for anything shown publicly.
- **Moderation load:** each public feature adds review work for admins; Phase 4's AI help reduces it.

How to measure it

Track these from the start of Phase 1 so each feature can be judged on results.

Metric	What it tells you
Form completion rate	How many visitors who start a report finish it (the new 4-step form, languages, offline drafts).
Return visits to tracking	Whether passengers come back to follow their report.
Average outcome rating	Whether passengers are satisfied with how reports are handled.
Reports from QR codes	Whether the bus stickers bring in new reports.
Time to first response	How quickly admins act once messages and notifications exist.

Timeline at a glance

Phase	Duration	Headline outcome
1. Quick wins	~2 weeks	More people can and do report: local languages, QR codes, offline drafts.
2. Public results	2–3 weeks	Visible impact builds trust and brings repeat reports.
3. Two-way contact	3–4 weeks	Passengers are kept informed and can be asked for details.
4. Ecosystem	Ongoing	Operators take part; admins work faster with AI help.